



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags are dealt with here!

### DVD burning takes too long

**Q** I have a problem with my computer. The DVD burning process takes too long on my system. My system configuration is an Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 1 GB RAM all running on an original Intel 945 motherboard. I used to burn DVDs using Nero 7, but now it takes more than an hour to burn. Please give me a solution for this problem.

Lakshmikandh K

**A** The slow DVD burning speed could be due to a faulty driver or software. The easiest thing to do is uninstall the drive from the device manager. If you're running Windows XP, go to Start > Control Panel > System.

Click on the Hardware tab and then on the Device Manager button. Double-click on DVD / CD-ROM drives heading, right-click on your DVD drive and click Uninstall. Reboot and let the drive be auto-detected again. Also, try uninstalling Nero and reinstalling it. Try using other software and different media. If nothing works, it could be a failing drive. Try the drive on another computer to verify this.

### Doubts on memory and 64-bit computing

**Q** My 3-GHz Intel processor supports 64-bit, but the Windows XP version I'm using is 32-bit. These are my questions.

1. I want to buy additional RAM. Will my system support DDR2 RAM? If not, specify which DDR1 RAM will be best and its price?
2. Can I use both (512 MB/1 GB RAM) with my existing 256 MB RAM?
3. After installing the RAM, how can I use my PC

with best performance and best visual effect?

4. Does the paging file affect computer performance? Please specify how much paging file & virtual memory I will use after installing the extra RAM?

Antu Kanta

**A** Your current motherboard supports DDR1 memory upto DDR400 only. DDR RAM is expensive today and not easily available, so you will have to look around.

The motherboard you use supports upto 2GB of RAM. To avoid any complications due to compatibility issues, use the same brand of memory.

The settings for best visual effect and quality can be enabled by clicking on first going to the Advanced tab under Device Manager in the Control Panel. Click on the Settings button under Performance, and click the radio button for Adjust for best appearance.

The paging file doesn't directly affect performance, but it can be used when your system runs out of physical memory. You can allot 2-3GB of space for the page or even let Windows set the page file size for you.

### Problem regarding flash

**Q** I have a Sony Digital Cybershot DSC-H9 camera. My problem is that its flash has stopped working. Instead, it shows me E:91:01 on the screen. My friend says that this is an error. Please help me out

Rohit Kumar

**A** Your friend is right. E:91:01 is an error code. In this case, it is to do with the flash. You need to take your camera to a Sony service centre to get the flash repaired or replaced.

### Need suggestions for purchasing hardware

**Q** I want to buy a desktop with the following configuration

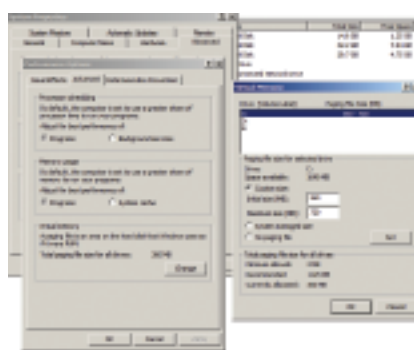
Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E8400  
Motherboard: Intel DP45SG  
Memory: 8 GB DDR2 800 Mhz  
HDD: Seagate 320 GB HDD  
Graphics card: ATI HD 4670  
Optical drive: Samsung DVD writer

I have four questions

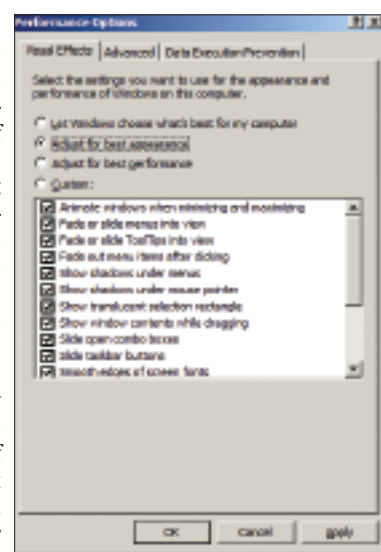
1. Does an Intel motherboard and processor support ATI graphics cards?
2. Which is better - 8 GB DDR2 or 4 GB DDR3 RAM?
3. What power supply unit should I use?
4. Will this motherboard work without a graphics card?

I would like to know your suggestions.

Athiq



Virtual memory can be set manually as well



Performance and Quality settings for Windows

### Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to [sos@thinkdigit.com](mailto:sos@thinkdigit.com), and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

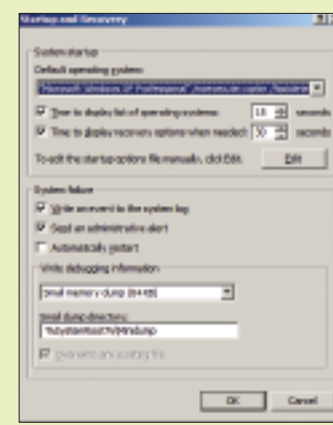
### Reinstalling my operating system

**Q** I have an Intel Core 2 Duo Processor (1.86 GHz) and a Foxconn motherboard based on the Intel 945 chipset. I have two Western Digital hard disks of 320GB each. In the first hard drive I have installed XP Professional and in the second one I have installed Vista Ultimate. Now whenever something seriously goes wrong with any of my operating systems, I go in for a fresh installation. But when I install a fresh copy of XP on my hard drive, the Windows Vista Boot Manager is no longer accessible. I'm no longer able to boot into Vista without installing it over again. My question – is there any way to bring back the old Boot Manager without installing another fresh copy of Vista?

Swaranga Sarma

**A** You don't have to reinstall Vista everytime you reinstall XP. If you have more than one operating system on your computer, you can set the one that you want to use as the default one, for when you start your computer by following these steps.

Go to Start > Control Panel. Double-click on System. On the Advanced tab, under Startup and Recovery, click Settings.



Startup Settings can be changed in the Startup and Recovery

Under System startup, in the default operating system list, click the operating system that you want to start when you turn on or restart your computer.

Select the list of operating systems for check box, and then type the number of seconds for which you want the list displayed before the default operating system starts automatically.

There's another way to get it running.

After installing one of the operating systems, insert the bootable CD / DVD of the other operating system. When you reach that screen with the option to Install Windows XP / Vista or Repair Windows. Select repair your system. Now you will reach a prompt.

Type fixboot and press [Enter]. Enter Y to confirm the command. Next, type fixmbr and follow the same steps.

Restart, and both your operating systems should be accessible.

Danish Chopra, TECH QNA Expert

**A** Yes, Intel motherboards can be used with ATI graphics cards. If you're building your system for games, then an ATI Radeon HD4870 would be better than the HD4670. The ATI Radeon HD4850 or the NVIDIA GeForce 9800 GTX are also good cheaper options to consider.

Currently, the advantages of more memory and faster bandwidth memory aren't very visible. In short, 4GB of DDR2 will be cheap and much more than sufficient, for any kind of desktop applications including multimedia content development. It also works out to be lot cheaper than 4GB of good DDR3 memory. For general desktop use, 2GB of DDR2 will do too.

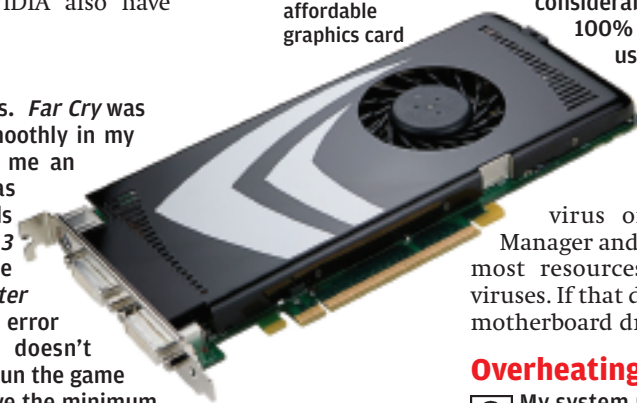
If you purchase a high-end graphics card, then you need a 600W PSU at least. The Corsair HX620 is a well known model.

The P45 chipset doesn't come with an onboard graphics chip. For onboard graphics from Intel, look for an Intel G45-based motherboard. The recently released GeForce 9300-based motherboards from NVIDIA also have onboard graphics.

### Gaming problem

**Q** I brought four original games. *Far Cry* was one of them, and it runs smoothly in my computer. *Resident Evil 4* gives me an error saying that game.exe has encountered a problem and needs to be closed. *Devil May Cry 3 Special Edition* also has the same problem as *Resident Evil*. *Splinter Cell Chaos Theory* also gives an error saying that my graphics card doesn't support Pixel Shader 1.1. When I run the game detection utility, it says that I have the minimum system configuration to run this game. What should I do?

The GeForce 9600GT - an affordable graphics card



My system configuration is as follows:

Processor - Intel Core 2 Duo  
Motherboard - Intel DG31GL with 256MB chipset graphics  
RAM - 1GB DDR2

Dimitri

**A** For the games you've mentioned, you should use a dedicated graphics solution and not an onboard G31-based solution. Invest in a PCI-E graphics card such as a GeForce 9600 GT, which can be bought for around Rs 6,000. This will run these games for sure and also allow you to run them at the best resolution and quality.

### 100% CPU utilisation

**Q** I have a Pentium 4 2.80GHz, 2GB RAM desktop with a 500GB HDD running a licensed copy of Windows XP with Service Pack 2 installed. Of late, I find the PC responding to commands after a considerable delay. The CPU usage shows 100% and the fan runs at full speed. I use the PC mainly for word processing, data processing and playing some music and movies.

Soma Dutta

**A** The slowdown is most likely to be some kind of a virus or trojan. Open up the Task Manager and look for the processes using the most resources. Also scan your system for viruses. If that doesn't work, try reinstalling the motherboard drivers.

### Overheating processor

**Q** My system uses an Intel Core 2 Duo, an Intel 945 motherboard, 1GB RAM and a 160-GB HDD. My system shuts down due to the overheat-